

Tidy

a spreadsheet that explains itself

User Manual

Tidy runs entirely in your browser as a single, self-contained file — no installation, no account, no server. Your data never leaves your computer.

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1. Getting Started

Tidy is a browser-based spreadsheet — open the HTML file in any modern browser and it works immediately, with no installation and no internet connection required after the page loads. Everything you type is saved automatically to your browser's local storage, so closing and reopening the file picks up right where you left off.

The screen at a glance

- **Ribbon tabs** (Home, Insert, Data, View) — switch between different groups of tools.
- **Toolbar** — the buttons for whichever tab is active: fonts, alignment, borders, number formats, freeze panes, and more.
- **Formula bar** — shows the cell reference (like B4) and lets you type or edit a cell's contents.
- **Grid** — the spreadsheet itself.
- **Sidekick panel** — on the right, explains whatever formula is in the selected cell in plain English, and offers a clickable function cheat sheet.
- **Sheet tabs** — at the bottom, for adding, duplicating, renaming, and switching between sheets.

Selecting and moving around

Action	How
Select a cell	Click it, or use the arrow keys.
Select a range	Click and drag, or click one cell then Shift-click another.
Select a whole row/column	Click the row number or column letter. Drag across several to select more than one.
Select everything	Click the blank corner box above row 1 and left of column A.
Jump to a specific cell	Type a reference like A1 or a range like A1:D50 into the name box (top-left) and press Enter.
Move after typing	Tab moves right, Enter moves down.

Entering data and formulas

Click a cell and start typing to enter a value. To enter a formula instead, start with an equals sign:

```
=SUM(A1:A5)
```

Press Enter or Tab to confirm, or Escape to cancel without saving the change. Ctrl+Z undoes, and Ctrl+Y (or Ctrl+Shift+Z) redoes — Tidy keeps a full undo history for the session.

Tip

Not sure what a formula in a cell does? Click on it and check the Sidekick panel on the right — it translates the formula into a plain-English sentence automatically.

2. The Sidekick Panel

The Sidekick is Tidy's built-in helper, always visible on the right side of the screen. It has two jobs: explaining formulas, and helping you build them.

Plain-English explanations

Click any cell that contains a formula, and the Sidekick translates it into a sentence. For example, selecting a cell containing:

```
=IF(A1>10, "yes", "no")
```

shows an explanation like:

"A1 is greater than 10, then 'yes', otherwise 'no'."

The cheat sheet

Below the explanation box, the Sidekick lists every supported function with a one-line description. Click any entry to insert a template version of that formula into the active cell, ready for you to fill in the specific ranges or values.

The XLOOKUP wizard

XLOOKUP is the most powerful function Tidy supports, and also the easiest to get wrong by hand. Click the **XLOOKUP** entry in the cheat sheet (or the fx button near the formula bar) to open a guided wizard: click "Pick", then click or drag directly on the sheet to fill in each part of the formula — what to look up, where to search, and what to return — without typing a single cell reference yourself.

Tip

You can look up values on a different sheet too. Just click into that sheet's tab while the wizard is picking a range, then click the cells you want there.

3. Formulas

Every formula starts with an equals sign. Tidy supports the following functions:

Function	What it does
<code>SUM(range)</code>	Adds up every number in a range.
<code>AVERAGE(range)</code>	Averages every number in a range.
<code>MIN(range)</code>	The smallest value in a range.
<code>MAX(range)</code>	The largest value in a range.
<code>COUNT(range)</code>	Counts how many cells in a range contain numbers.
<code>IF(test, yes, no)</code>	Returns one value if a condition is true, another if false.
<code>ROUND(value, digits)</code>	Rounds a number to the given number of decimal places.
<code>ABS(value)</code>	Removes a negative sign from a number.
<code>CONCAT(a, b, ...)</code>	Joins text and values together into one piece of text.
<code>XLOOKUP(value, search_range, return_range)</code>	Finds a value in one range and returns the matching value from another range, in the same relative position.

Referencing other sheets

A formula can pull data from a different sheet by naming it before the cell reference, separated by an exclamation point. If the sheet's name contains a space (like Tidy's default "Sheet 1"), wrap the name in single quotes:

```
= 'Sheet 1' !A1
=SUM(Budget !A1:A10)
```

This works inside any function, including XLOOKUP, so you can look a value up on one sheet and return a result from another.

A few limits to know about

- Whole-column references like `A:A` aren't supported — use a bounded range instead, such as `A1:A1000`.
- Circular references (a formula that refers back to itself, directly or through other cells) are caught and flagged rather than silently miscalculating — even when the loop runs through more than one sheet.

4. Formatting Cells

Select one or more cells, then use the Home tab to format them. Most formatting tools apply to the whole selection at once.

Text

- **Bold, italic, underline** — the B / I / U buttons.
- **Font family** — a dropdown with several common typefaces.
- **Text size** — the slider in the Font group (8–32px).
- **Text color** — the row of swatches under Text Color.

Alignment

- **Horizontal** — Left, Center, Right.
- **Vertical** — Top, Middle, Bottom (most useful combined with taller rows).
- **Orientation** — rotate text 45° up, 45° down, or 90°, for angled column headers. Combine with Bottom vertical alignment for the classic diagonal-header look.

Fill color & banded rows

Apply a solid fill to selected cells from the Fill Color swatches, including plain white and a "No Fill" option. For an alternating stripe pattern across the whole sheet instead, use **Banded Rows** (View tab) — it lightly tints every other row automatically, and any cell you've given its own fill color always keeps it. A row of swatches next to the button lets you choose which color to band with.

Borders

Button	Effect
Bottom / Top	Adds a border to just that edge of the selected cells.
All	Adds a border around every cell in the selection.
Outline	Adds a border only around the outside edge of the selection.
None	Removes borders from the selected cells.

Number formats

The Number dropdown offers General, Number, Currency, and Percent. Use the decimal buttons (the decimal increase/decrease buttons next to the Number dropdown) to add or remove decimal places.

Checkboxes

Select cells and click **Checkbox** to turn them into interactive checkboxes instead of plain text — useful for to-do lists and tracking sheets. The underlying value is TRUE or FALSE, so checkbox cells still work in formulas.

5. Rows, Columns & Sheets

Resizing

- **Columns** — hover the boundary between two column letters until the cursor changes, then drag. Double-click the boundary to auto-fit the column to its widest content.
- **Rows** — the same, on the boundary at the bottom of a row. Every row can be resized independently of every other row.
- **Resizing several at once** — select multiple whole rows or columns first (via their headers, or Select All), then drag any one of their dividers — the rest resize to match. Double-clicking instead auto-fits each one individually to its own content.
- **Exact width** — right-click a column (or use the Insert tab's "Col Width..." button) to type a precise pixel value.

Inserting & deleting

Right-click a row or column header for Insert/Delete options, or use the buttons in the Insert tab.

Freeze panes

In the View tab, **Freeze row** keeps row 1 pinned in place while you scroll down, and **Freeze col** keeps column A pinned while you scroll right — handy for keeping headers or labels visible in a large sheet.

Gridlines

Choose Off, or one of three intensities (1 = light, 2 = medium, 3 = dark) from the View tab.

Working with multiple sheets

To...	Do this
Add a sheet	Click the + button next to the sheet tabs.
Rename a sheet	Double-click its tab name.
Duplicate a sheet	Click the small duplicate icon on its tab — the copy is placed right next to the original.
Switch sheets	Click a different tab.
Delete a sheet	Click the × icon on its tab (not available if it's the only sheet left).

6. Importing & Exporting Files

Importing

Drag a CSV, TSV, XLSX, or XLS file directly onto the browser window to import it. Importing an Excel workbook brings in every sheet it contains, each as its own tab in Tidy.

Exporting

Button	What it produces
Export CSV	The active sheet only, as a plain CSV file.
Export XLSX	The entire workbook — every sheet, with formatting preserved: fonts, colors, fills, borders, alignment, rotation, number formats, column widths, row heights, and frozen panes all carry over into the Excel file.

Note

Excel doesn't have true cross-sheet formula syntax identical to Tidy's, so formulas export as their calculated values — the numbers and text will be correct, but a formula referencing another sheet won't re-calculate live inside Excel.

7. Find & Replace

Click **Find** in the Home tab, or press Ctrl+F, to open the Find & Replace panel.

- Searches both formulas and the values they display.
- **Find Next** cycles through every match, wrapping around at the end.
- **Replace** replaces the current match and moves to the next.
- **Replace All** replaces every match on the sheet in a single, undoable step.

Note

Find & Replace searches the sheet you're currently on, not the whole workbook.

8. Printing

Click **Print** in the header. Tidy temporarily renders the full sheet (not just the portion currently visible on screen) and hides its own toolbar and panels, so what prints is just your data — well suited to checklists and handouts. The normal scrolling view returns automatically once you close the print dialog.

9. Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+Z	Undo
Ctrl+Y / Ctrl+Shift+Z	Redo
Ctrl+C / Ctrl+V	Copy / paste
Ctrl+X	Cut
Ctrl+A	Select all
Ctrl+F	Open Find & Replace
Ctrl+;	Insert today's date into the active cell
Tab / Enter	Move right / down after typing
Delete / Backspace	Clear the selected cells
Arrow keys	Move the active cell
Shift + click	Extend the current selection
Alt+Enter	Insert a line break inside a cell while editing

10. Tips & Troubleshooting

Your data is saved automatically

Tidy saves to your browser's local storage as you work — there's no manual save button, and no risk of losing changes if you close the tab. Storage is specific to the exact file location it's opened from, so keep working from the same copy of the file if you want your data to still be there next time.

Starting over

The **Reset** button (top right) clears every sheet in the workbook and starts fresh. This can't be undone, so Tidy asks you to confirm first.

If a column or row won't resize

Make sure you're hovering directly over the thin boundary line between two column letters (or at the bottom edge of a row) — the cursor changes to a resize icon when you're in the right spot. If you need an exact width rather than a dragged one, right-click the column and choose "Set column width..." to type a precise pixel value instead.

Large sheets

Tidy supports up to 50,000 rows and 60 columns per sheet. Only the rows currently visible on screen are actually drawn at any moment (a technique called virtual scrolling), which is what keeps even very large sheets scrolling smoothly.